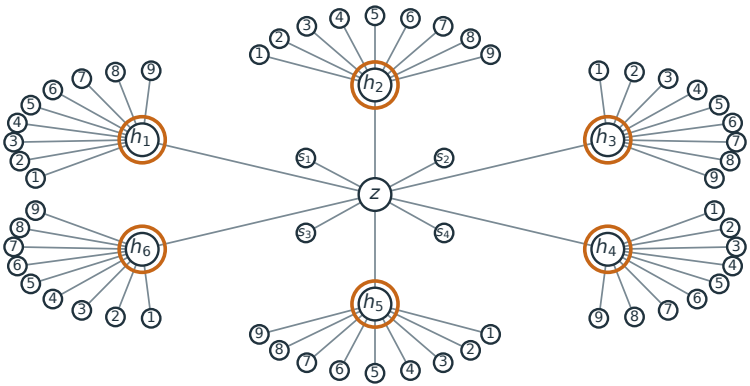
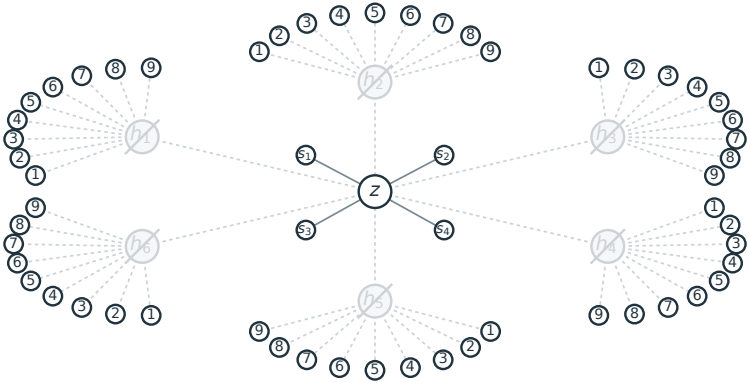
(a) Step 4 - Before: peel the six hubs



$\mathrm{cl}_z = 4 \le 9/2$; $\mathrm{cl}_{h_i} = 9 > 9/2$

(b) Step 4 - After: the center survives, with degree 4



$\deg(z) : 10 \to 4$; all 54 hub leaves remain uncommitted.

A leaf marked j next to hub h_i is the vertex $u_{i,j}$.

The two panels use identical locations; no leaf groups are collapsed.